



HaBits Portfolio Piece

Nimra Javed, Cathy Ly, Al Rajala, JJ Sheehan

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Project Overview

HaBits is a habit tracking app designed for individuals who want to build and maintain healthy routines through customizable habits, reminders, and integrations with external applications such as health trackers and music platforms. This app will be designed for both mobile phones and smart watches. The goal of this app is to make tracking habits easier for the user without requiring too much effort or time from their everyday lives.

Many existing habit tracking apps focus heavily on productivity and fitness goals, which can be too overwhelming for users who are trying to slowly make changes in their lifestyle. This can negatively impact their interactions with many habit tracking apps. HaBits is created to address this issue by providing a very customizable application that provides a variety of habits, including fitness, wellness, creative pursuits, and personal growth activities. HaBits allows users to create custom habits and categories, which they are able to organize according to their preferences. The primary goal of this application is to give users greater control over their habit tracking experience, without unnecessarily pressuring the user.

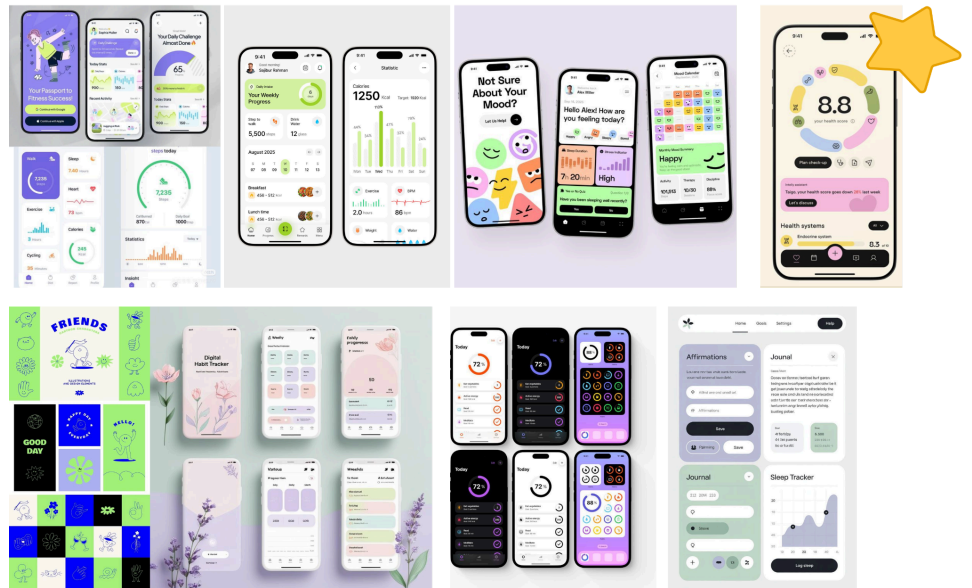
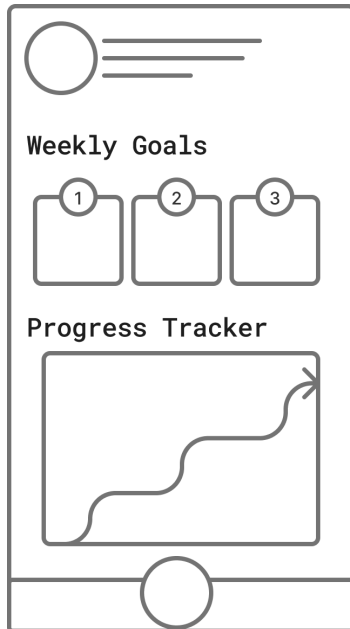
Design Goals

Our idea included some features that we thought the habit tracking app should have. These features included:

- Categories for habits
- The ability to make custom habits and categories
- Syncing with other services in order to automatically check off created habits
- The ability to drag and drop parts (bits) of the homescreen to customize layout

Lo-fi Prototype and Moodboard

To create a lo-fi prototype, we did a design charette. We set time aside during our meeting to individually sketch out ideas based on what we each thought HaBits should look like. Then we went over these sketches and made one group sketch. We concluded the design charette having decided what the home screen of the app should look like (pictured below) and with some ideas for future prototyping. During this meeting, we also created a moodboard to start getting some ideas for the visual language of the app. The design we liked the most from the moodboard and decided to move forward with is indicated by a star.



Personas

Ophelia - Age 27

Tagline: "I'm very active but no matter how much I run off my stress, it feels like it keeps coming back!"

Ophelia is an active fitness-lover who enjoys tracking and seeing her fitness progress. Usually she uses fitness as an outlet for her daily stressors, but lately Ophelia has been feeling that she has been falling behind in her mental health, and is looking for a way to slowly build practices in addition to her fitness regimen (journaling, meditation, positive self-talk). She finds that many other mental-health apps are hard for her to continue using as they tend to shame her for not using them. Ophelia is looking for a way to make baby steps towards balance between her mental health and fitness.

Josie - Age 43

Tagline: "I'm struggling to see any real progress with my art and I'm beginning to feel discouraged."

Josie is an avid journaler and meditation practitioner. He finds comfort in working on his art, but recently has been wanting a way to track his hobby as he struggles to stay organized and observe his own progress. Josie has been feeling stagnant and

wants to add more of a fitness practice to his life after he was gifted a FitBit for his birthday, but is intimidated by many of the more “aggressive” fitness apps that are on the market. He has tried fitness apps before, but finds himself burnt out from diving into the deep end too quickly. Josie wants something flexible that tracks his art progress but also caters to the physical side of his mental-health as well (stretching, yoga, jogging).

Narrative Prototype

Following the creation of the lo-fi prototype and personas, we created a narrative prototype using the Josie persona as proof of concept. This presentation presented a scenario in which the persona would use HaBits and the features it would include that make it different from other habit tracking apps, including the ability to choose metrics for habits and customize the homescreen.

Mid-Fi Prototype

<https://www.figma.com/design/0fgfmt5MuOKbooU1sCa4VM/HCI-430-Mid-Fi-BEFORE?node-id=42-2503&p=f&t=IF8K8BfHGDgjN1Nz-0>

Usability Testing

We conducted usability testing using our mid-fidelity prototype. The goal of this usability testing was to discover if the navigation of our app allowed users to complete key tasks involved in the use of the app. We asked participants to complete four tasks, three using the prototype for the phone app and one for the smart watch platform. The first task was to create an account, the second was to create a habit, and the third was to sync that habit to an external account. For the smartwatch application, we asked participants to simply check off a specific habit. The full test protocol is available in the Appendix.

Issues Identified

During our usability testing, we identified some issues with our design. Firstly, the sync button that allowed habits to be synced with outside services was located in the habit settings, rather than being somewhere more accessible. Furthermore, it was a

small button that was easily ignored in favor of the submit button at the bottom of the screen. Another problem we identified was the wording of the prototype. There were a few places in the prototype where it referred directly to a “task” which was confusing to participants. We also lacked clear iconography, like plus signs where participants were supposed to click to create new habits.

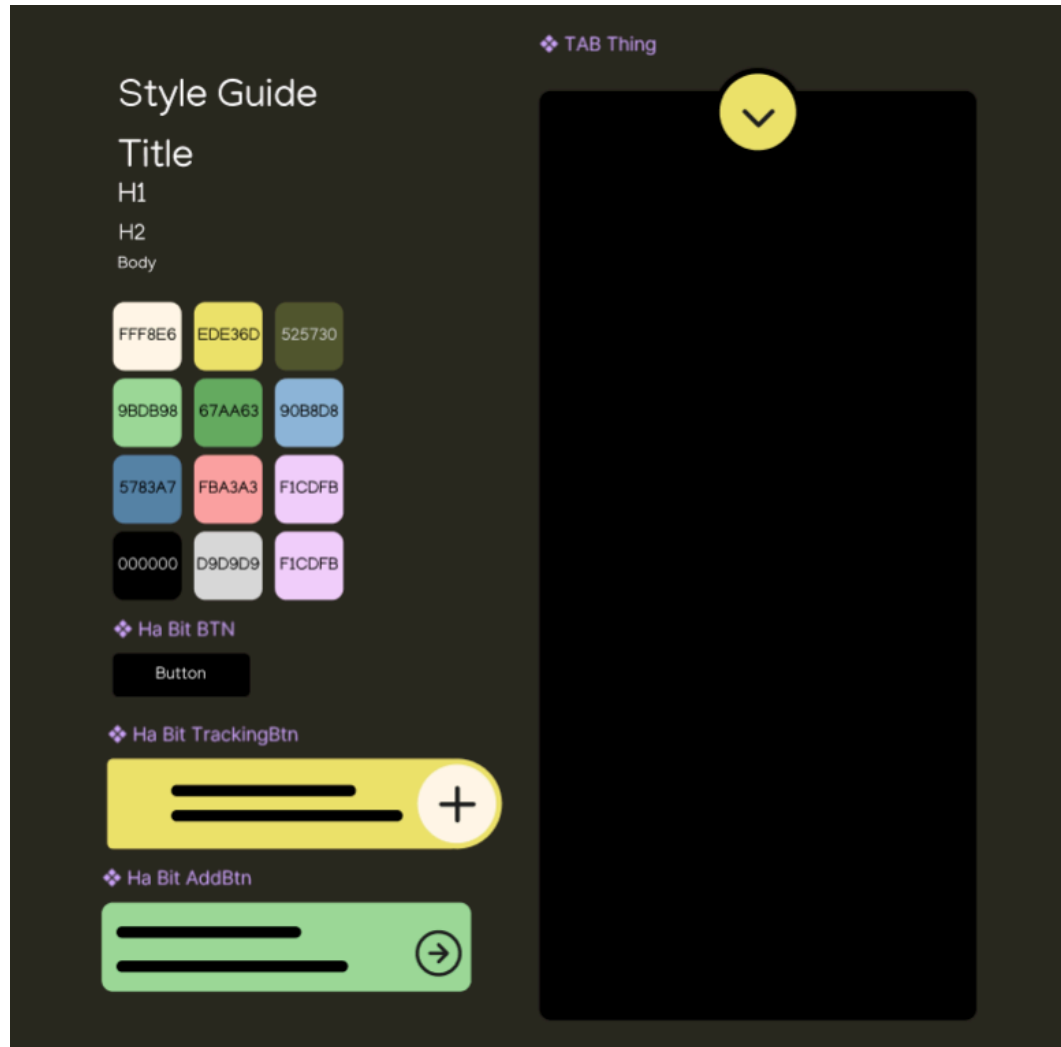
Revisions

After our usability testing, we worked on creating a high fidelity prototype that solved the problems uncovered by testing. We placed the sync button on the main dashboard rather than in habit settings to make it more accessible to users. We also changed some iconography to include plus signs rather than exclamation points where users were adding habits or creating new content. We also changed the wording in the prototype to refer to habits rather than tasks.

Hi-Fi Prototype

<https://www.figma.com/design/w1FPvEE3PulwuWC6yrUjle/HCI-430-narrative-prototype?node-id=42-2503&p=f&t=0WDhETEokL6ufcal-0>

Style Guide



Summary

By working our way through each iteration of prototypes, we were able to create a successful high-fidelity prototype with navigation that makes sense to our users. Feedback gathered during the testing helped guide us through any design issues and improvements needed to strengthen our user interactions. Our next steps would be to test the high-fidelity prototype to see if the changes we made were successful and discover if there were other issues that we didn't find in our first round of testing. The continued cycle of testing and refining, will help strengthen HaBits in creating a more personalized experience for users.

Appendix

Test Plan:

INTRODUCTION

Hello! I'm [name] and I'll be your test moderator today. I'm working on a group project for my prototyping and implementation class. We've designed a mobile and watch app, a habit tracker, that can be synced with other services like Spotify or health apps.

This activity is to test the navigation of our application. I will give you four tasks to complete using the prototype of our software and be taking notes occasionally. Please say what you are thinking aloud while you complete these tasks. We find that participants who speak their thoughts aloud provide valuable insights into the design, no matter how small or insignificant the thought may seem. Remember that this is not a fully functioning app and some functionality will not be present, such as typing input.

This activity will be recorded. The notes and recordings will be shared with the research team and may be viewed by the professor of our class.

Don't be afraid of making mistakes, there are no right or wrong answers to these tasks. We are testing the application, not you. Any issues that arise are due to the design of the application and will help us improve that design in the future.

Your participation is entirely voluntary. You are not required to take this test or to finish it entirely. You may stop the test at any time for any reason.

TASK 1: ACCOUNT CREATION

START: Login Page

SCENARIO: Imagine you had just downloaded this app and didn't have an account. What would you do to get started with the app?

END: User creates account and lands on the Empty Home Page

Post-Task Questions

1. What did you find easy?
2. What did you find difficult?

TASK 2: CREATE A SUGGESTED HABIT

START: Empty Home Page

SCENARIO: Now that you have an account, it's time to start putting in habits you'd like to get into. Imagine that there were some preset habits you could add automatically. One of them is drinking more water. That sounds like a good thing to get into, so you decide to add it to your habit list. How would you do that?

END: User successfully adds the "Drink More Water" Habit & navigates back to the Updated Home Page

Post-Task Questions

1. What did you find easy?
2. What did you find difficult?

TASK 3: ADD A CUSTOM TRACKER

START: Updated Home Page

SCENARIO: The other thing that this app is known for doing is syncing with other services to automatically check habits as complete. Let's say you wanted to sync the habit of drinking water to a health app on your phone. How would you do that?

END: User successfully syncs device and navigates to Sync Confirmed Page

Post-Task Questions

1. What did you find easy?
2. What did you find difficult?

TASK 4: COMPLETE HABIT ON WATCH INTERFACE

START: Watch Homepage

SCENARIO: Lastly, imagine that you had this app on a smart watch of some kind. How would you mark a habit as complete on the watch and return to the home page?

END: User marks "Drink Water" as completed

Post-Task Questions

1. What did you find easy?
2. What did you find difficult?

Post-Test Questions

1. Is there anything you would change about this interface if you could?